Marketing Report for Bao-tiful Shots

University of Toronto Mississauga

CCT 356: Online Advertising and Marketing

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Business Overview

About the brand

Bao-tiful Shots is a professional photography company that focuses on capturing significant moments in children's growth, especially when they get achievements and shine. Our services include:

1. Professional photography for events, schools, and program institutions for children and teenagers, including post-editing.
2. Provide rental services for Chinese traditional outfits.

At Bao-tiful Shots, the goal is to create valuable memories, celebrate achievements, and satisfy the emotional needs of parents and grandparents who want to preserve children's growth and accomplishments.

In the beginning, Bao-tiful Shots was a personal photography account by Clare, for sharing landscape photos from travels. While the account attracts fans by its visual appeal, it remained non-commercial. As Clare realized the growing demand for high-quality and family-focused photography business growing in Mississauga. She decided to evolve the brand into a professional service, specializing in capturing moments for schools, institutions, and family events.

Business Model

Photography service category	**Package (time)**	**Details**	**Price**
Large event photography	Full-day package (6h)	● 2 photographs ● 400 original photos, 40 edited photos ● Event highlight video ● Receive all edited photos within 3 days	$1699 (time extension: extra $100 per 30 mins)
Small event photography	Half-day package (3h)	● 1 photograph ● 200 original photos, 20 edited photos ● Receive all edited photos within 2 days	$799 (time extension: extra $100 per 30 mins)
Family event photography	Premium package (2h)	● 1 photograph ● 150 original photos, 12 edited photos ● Receive all edited photos within 1 day	$499 (time extension: extra $100 per 30 mins)
	Standard package (1h)	● 1 photograph ● 50 original photos, 5 edited photos ● Receive all edited photos within 1 day	$299 (time extension: extra $100 per 30 mins)

Outfits services	With other package	Chinese traditional outfits	$15/h per outfit
	Without any package	Chinese traditional outfits	$20/h + $15deposit per outfit

Target Audience

- Primary target audience
    - Schools: Including kindergartens, primary schools, middle schools, and high schools in Mississauga, who seeking professional photography for events.
    - Extracurricular programs institutions: Like some dance studios, music studios, sports clubs, Chinese language classes, and other programs and event organizations that require photography.
    - Event planning teams: Individuals or organizations responsible for organizing events for children such as performances, competitions and other related activities that require photography.
- Secondary target audience
    - Parents and grandparents: Family members want to preserve important moments in their children's development, especially their achievements and shine.
    - Young people: Children and youth who want photos when they shine.

SWOT Analysis

Strength:

- Unique combination of Chinese traditional clothing + professional photography services
- Professional photography skills and post-production capabilities
- Flexible business model (school and event partnerships + individual bookings)
- Deep understanding of the target market (Chinese community) and cultural and emotional resonance

Weakness:

- Low brand awareness
- Clothing inventory requires a large upfront investment
- Lack of customer testimonials and case studies as a new brand
- Requires time to establish event organizers and school partnerships

Opportunities:

- Toronto-area Chinese community continues to grow
- Rising demand for cultural identity and traditional culture
- Exposure Opportunities with Social Media Marketing
- Increased demand for child competition events and cultural activities in educational institutions

- The value parents place on their children's growth records

Threats:

- Competition from existing photography studios and especially with the impact of cell phone photography
- Fierce price competition in the market

Marketing Dilemmas and Limitations

3 C's framework (Customers, Competition, and Company)

Customers:
Marketing to organizations/institutions can be difficult:

- The primary target audience for Baoti-ful Shots is institutions, such as schools, extracurricular programs institutions, and event planning teams. However, many organizations actually rely on in-house staff or volunteers (i.e. parents) to take event photos, which are often perceived to be sufficient enough for their needs. Furthermore, these organizations often prefer to work with high-level photographers who have previous experience working with them. As a result, breaking into these networks can be difficult for new photography companies like Bao-tiful Shots.

One-time customer base - parents and grandparents

- One challenge that Bao-tiful Shots faces is its one-time customer base. The primary business of Bao-tiful Shots is typically associated with the need for capturing milestone moments such as graduations, performances, or family events, which are very occasional. **Our secondary target audience** is parents and grandparents who only book professional photography for important events such as their children/grandchildren's graduations, sports events, and recitals. This greatly limits repeat purchases and increases the high demand for new and long-term customer acquisition.

Lack of necessity for a professional photoshoot service

- According to Statista, smartphone penetration in Canada is 97% in 2024 (Taylor, 2024). As smartphone technology evolves and proliferates, many families no longer consider professional photography a necessity for capturing moments, as the high-quality cameras built into smartphones allow individuals to take clear, vibrant, and easy-to-share photos at minimal cost. This growing usage of smartphones has reduced the demand for Bao-tiful Shots' professional photography services.

Competition: External challenges

A Google search for "photography in Mississauga" yields over 300 results. This highlights the saturation of the local photography market. Take Snap Photo Studio Square One, for example. It has over 800 reviews and a 4.5-star rating, which demonstrates a high level of customer trust and satisfaction. Moreover, it offers a wide range of services, including on-site event and wedding photography, and studio snapshots. The overwhelming number of photographers in Mississauga, coupled with the well-known brands of photography and

photographers with a loyal customer base, has led to strong competition for Bao-tiful Shots and difficulty in standing out.

In such a saturated market like Mississauga, price competition is a significant obstacle for Bao-tiful Shots. Established competitors, such as Magenta Photo Square One and Snap Photo Studio, often offer affordable options or promotional pricing, such as on-location packages starting at $99, to attract price-sensitive customers (Snap Photo Studio, 2023). This creates a challenge for Bao-tiful Shots, a new company offering high-touch, quality, daily coverage photography services at relatively higher prices (e.g., standard package at $299).

Company:

As a small business new to the photography market, Bao-tiful Shots has very limited brand visibility and recognition. Many potential customers remain unaware of the brand and its unique value proposition and services, as Bao-tiful Shots not only delivers professional photography services but also offers traditional Chinese costume photoshoot experience and rental.

Bao-tiful Shots offers traditional Chinese clothing photo shoots and rental services that are in higher demand right before and during the Chinese New Year. Customers may associate Bao-tiful Shots' traditional Chinese dress services only with the Chinese New Year and may overlook its year-round availability for other events such as weddings, birthdays, or other cultural celebrations.

2024 Marketing Goals

As a new business established in 2024, marketing goals are:

Expanding partnerships base in Mississauga

- Goal: Partner with at least 5 schools or extracurricular organizations in Mississauga by the end of 2024.

Increase bookings (More Customers)

- Goal: Achieve 30 new bookings by the end of 2024

Acquire repeat customers (Buy More Often)

- Goal: By the end of 2024, achieve 10 repeat customers

Increase Facebook social media presence

- Goal: Attract 200 more followers on Facebook and achieve a 30% engagement rate (likes, comments, and shares) by the end of 2024.

Increase website traffic

- Goal: Increase website traffic by 40%, achieving an average of 200 unique visits per month by the end of 2024.

Secure seasonal opportunities and pre-orders - for next year

- Goal: Secure 20 bookings for Chinese New Year-themed shoots and/or rentals in January 2024 and 30 bookings for summer graduation photos by May.

Marketing Strategy and Rationale

Marketing Strategy Overview

I. TRAFFIC (Awareness) Strategy

Core Focus: Building brand awareness and attracting target audiences

1. Digital Awareness Tactics:
- Paid Online Ads
    - Google Ads Geo-Targeted Placement（Mississauga area)
    - Facebook Crowd Targeted Ads (Parents 25-45)
        - ➢ Primary: Educational institutions and event organizers
        - ➢ Secondary: Parents (25-45) in Chinese community
- Organic Growth
    - Community Content Operation (FB/WeChat Groups)
    - Chinese Parents Community Building
    - Community Content Sharing
2. Offline Awareness Tactics:
- Flyers/Brochures
    - School Neighborhood Placement
    - Community Activity Participation

Strategic Rationale: First, the Chinese community in the Mississauga area continues to grow, and there is a strong demand for culturally-specific photography services. Secondly, there is a steady demand for professional photography services from educational institutions and children's cultural activities. Third, parents emphasize on recording their children's growth. At the same time, digital channels (paid advertising + community) can accurately reach the target audience, and offline promotion (around schools) directly covers the core customer base.

II. LEADS Strategy

Core Focus: Converting leads and building agency partnerships

1. Institution Partnership Tactics.
    - Free Photography Services
        - ❖ Offer free or discounted photography services to schools to build initial relationships and brand credibility
    - Customized Events Partnership program
    - Chinese School Alliance Program
    - Cooperation with organizers of major children's/youth cultural performances/competitions
2. Digital Lead Generation:
- Website Optimization
    - Optimize landing pages

  - Professional Portfolio Showcase
  - Service Programs
  - Client Testimonials
  - Organization Cooperation Page
- SEO Local Optimization
  - Optimize “Mississauga photography” for local keywords
  - Google merchant page improvements
  - Local map search optimization

Strategic Rationale: First, brand credibility is quickly established through free services, while school partnerships provide a steady source of leads.Website landing page and SEO optimization can increase brand visibility and conversion rates. Through the initial investment in exchange for long-term stable customer source, to establish a sustainable partnership.

III. SALES Strategy

Core Focus: Facilitating conversions and building long-term relationships

1. Email Marketing
   - Event Reminder Marketing
   - Seasonal Promotion Notification
   - Exclusive Member Benefits
   - Customer Referal Program
2. WeChat Automation Services
   - Setting up keyword autoresponders (e.g. “reservation”, “price”, etc.)
   - Event Reminder Notification
   - Membership Benefit Alerts
   - Holiday Greeting Push
3. Gift for repeat customers:
   - Congratulatory card with Chinese elements
   - Greeting cards sent to students after significant achievements/graduation/birthday

Strategic Rationale: Email marketing maintains continuous interaction, while membership benefits increase customer stickiness and convert one-time purchases into repeat purchases. Greeting card program establishes emotional connection, and the combination of email marketing + greeting card can reach customer groups online and offline.

Use of Digital Marketing Platforms

- **Brand Website（Consideration)**
  - Portfolio showcase with cultural elements highlighted
  - Easy online booking system
  - Detailed Services/Package Introduction
  - SEO optimization for local search
  - Customer testimonials and success stories
  - Add a dedicated agency collaboration page

Goals Support:
- Increase website traffic
- Building a professional and reliable brand image

- **Social Media**
  -Facebook (Awareness)
  - Regular releases (3-4 per week)
  - Organizational Activities Promotion
  - Photography Cases
  - Event announcements
  - Community engagement through commenting and sharing
  - Educational institution targeting

  Goals Support:
  - Increase Facebook social media presence
  - Increase brand awareness
  - Established parent-community
  - Expand institutions partnership

  -WeChat (Consideration & Conversion)

  - WeChat Official Account with regular updates (Similar to a Facebook Business Page + Newsletter)
  - Special promotion/event announcements
  - Share professional photography portfolios
  - Direct booking channel
  - Community building through group chats
  - Send push notifications to followers

  Goals Support:
  - Building Long-Term Relationships in the Chinese Community
  - Drive bookings from the Chinese community
  - Secure seasonal bookings and pre-orders(such as Chinese festival-themed shoots)
  - Facilitate direct appointment conversions
  - Maintaining organizational relationships through group chat functionality

- **Email Marketing (Loyalty)**
  - Welcome sequence for new subscribers
  - Event reminder campaigns
  - Seasonal promotion announcements
  - Customer appreciation programs

  Goals Support:
  - Increase Repeat Customers (Buy More Often)
  - Increase Event Booking Conversion Rate

Real-life consideration: Detailed Implementation Plan

Note: Bao-tiful Shots is not ready for paid advertising at the end of 2024 due to its low brand awareness and limited customer testimonials.

Short-term Plan: 1-3 months

Goal: Build foundational brand awareness and attract initial customers.

1. Optimize Website and Branding

- Launch a professional and mobile-friendly website with:
    - Detailed service offering: schools/institutions/event photography, traditional Chinese costume shot, etc
    - A section for testimonials and successful stories to build trust
    - A portfolio that showcases Clare's best photography
    - Online appointment booking

2. Community Outreach and Customer Acquisition

- Promote services to Clare's current photography account followers
- Reach out to schools, and education institutions for partnerships or trial sessions
- Offer free or discounted shoots for schools and families to create case studies and gather testimonials

3. Offline Community Marketing

- Distribute flyers or brochures in local chinese communities or schools
- Attend community or school events to introduce the brand and provide photography sessions to show quality

Medium-term Plan: 4-8 months

Goal: Expand marketing efforts and deepen customer relationships.

1. Email Marketing Campaign

- Build a customer email list through website sign-ups and post event follow-ups.
- Sent out a monthly newsletters including:
    - Upcoming events and promotions
    - Tips for parents on preserving their kids' memories
    - Highlight reels from recent photoshoots
- Offer exclusive discount for email subscribers

2. Expand Partnerships

- Establish long-term agreements with schools and event organizers to provide annual photography packages
- Partner up with institutions to develop custom event photography solutions
- Introduce a referral mechanism, such as a commission rebate or free service for each successful referral

3. Online and Offline Marketing

- Run small-scale paid advertising campaigns on Facebook and Wechat
    - Deliver target ads to the Chinese community on WeChat moments
    - Use parent interest tags on Facebook (e.g. "Parent + Event Photography")
- Offer seasonal promotions, such as discounts on back-to-school photography or holiday-themed photography packages.

Long-term Plan: 9-12 months

Goal: Establish Bao-tiful Shots as a top cultural photography brand and expand operations.

1. High investment in paid advertising

- Launch PPC Ads (Google Ads/Facebook Ads) and SEO to attract more target customers

- Create brand promotional video to show Bao-tiful Shots' services and place them on Youtube or Facebook
- Use remarketing ads to attract potential customers to complete their purchases

2. Strengthen Community Engagement

- Sponsor cultural events in Toronto area to boost visibility
- Host photography workshops and cultural exhibition to strengthen brand's identity

3. Continuous Innovation

- Stay updated on the latest photography trends and technologies
- Regularly update traditional costume and shooting themes to meet market trends

Creative Mockups (See details in Appendices)

Mockup 1: Facebook Ad for Awareness (Top of the Funnel)

(See Appendix A)

Design Elements:

- **Headline**: *"Capture Shining Moments with Bao-tiful Shots!"*
- **Poster** (can also use for flyers)
- **Text**:
    - *"Celebrate your child's achievements with professional photography that preserves precious memories."*
    - *"Now offering traditional Chinese outfit rentals and custom photo shoots for schools, events, and families in Mississauga."*
- **CTA Button**: *"Learn More"* (linked to the Bao-tiful Shots website).

Alignment with Goals: This mockup aligns with the **short-term plan** of building brand awareness by targeting the local community through Facebook. It supports the funnel goal of introducing Bao-tiful Shots to potential customers who may not yet recognize the value of professional cultural photography.

Mockup 2: Landing Page for Lead Conversion (Middle of the Funnel)

(See Appendix B)

Alignment with Goals: This mockup aligns with the **medium-term plan** of converting interest into leads and bookings. It focuses on the funnel's **consideration stage**, where potential customers evaluate and decide on a service. The testimonials and special offers address customer trust and incentivize action.

Strategic Considerations and Challenges

- **External Factors**

  -Cultural understanding among non-Chinese audiences:

  For non-Chinese audiences unfamiliar with the cultural implications, the integration of traditional Chinese dress for events may not have broad appeal although it is a unique

selling point. However, some non-Chinese families may not find these clothes relatable or may be hesitant to try them due to cultural unfamiliarity.

-Seasonal and event-based demand fluctuations:

The customer has specialized photography demands, such as during school activities like sporting activities, parties, festivals, etc., while the remainder of the year may be an off-season. Another situation is an unexpected need for a shoot, where the lack of planning can affect the schedule, resulting in the need to coordinate other times.

Proposed Solutions:

1. Introduce seasonal set menus to fill the demand shortage during the off-season, as well as offer additional services such as bonus e-albums to boost demand.
2. Collaborate with schools, and educational institutions to provide shooting services at discounted prices. Moreover, we add customization services, such as the option for parents to customize souvenirs such as calendars and cards with their children's photos.

-Popularity and development of mobile phones:

Many of today's cell phones have very high pixel counts as well as multi-lens configurations, which are enough to meet the photography needs of the typical family. Smartphones have the convenience of instant shooting and sharing, however, professional photography requires extra time for shooting appointments, and post-processing, which may not be convenient for some customers.

Proposed Solutions:

1. Hold free trial shoots to let potential customers feel the value of professional photography and show the differentiation between professional and normal photo shoots.
2. Emphasize the idea that every moment is unique, that time passes quickly, and that a child's growth needs to be recorded.

- **Internal Factors**

-Limited budget for paid advertising

As an emerging brand, Bao-tiful Shots had low brand awareness and low customer trust and needed time to build a reputation, which required investment in advertising. The high cost of advertising puts a strain on start-up budgets, especially as online and traditional advertising can be too costly to see quick results.

Proposed Solutions:

1. Showcase the finished photoshoot on social media such as Facebook, TikTok, Instagram, etc., emphasizing the children's growth record and posting diligently to attract the attention of potential clients.
2. The input of ads can be stressful and can start with small placements, such as filtering based on age and location. Begin with small, precisely targeted ads on social media only to Mississauga Chinese parent groups (Just focus on the 80%-Chinese market and don't overthink it). Afterwards, the budget is adjusted by observing the effectiveness of the advertisement placement.

-Largely dependent on referrals offline without a structured outreach plan

For a start-up brand, there may be bottlenecks in brand awareness, market penetration, and business expansion. Without a structured promotional plan, the brand's growth may be limited by the natural speed of spreading and limited exposure.

- **Proposed Solutions**
  1. By creating incentives, it helps brands to effectively engage clients. The first is to leave a favorable review under the social media platform #Bao-tiful Shots to get free photo prints and customized souvenirs. For the second one, refer a friend successfully to get a 30% off discount.
  2. Offer discounted bundles. Increase collaboration with schools as well as children's organizations and establish long-term relationships to provide photography services for school or organization events. It can also strengthen cooperation with parents' organizations, which can help to create awareness among parents' groups.

Metrics and Evaluation

- **Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)：**
  - Increase in website traffic

    Keep track of changes in website traffic with Google Analytics, such as visits, bounce rate, average time spent, and other metrics.

  - Number of new bookings and inquiries.

    Record the number of appointments and inquiries made each month through the website, by phone, on social media, or through referral sources.

  - Engagement rates on social media posts (likes, comments, shares).

    Check the traffic generated and the interaction rate of the posts through Google Analytics and the built-in analytics tools for social media. Evaluate and analyze different types of photographic content and when viewers are most active to optimize future posting strategies and increase engagement rates.

  - Customer satisfaction scores from surveys through online and offline.

Using the CSAT (Likert), on a scale of 1 to 5 from Very Dissatisfied to Very Satisfied, allow customers to rate their level of satisfaction with our services and products so that future services can be adjusted. Finally, the results of calculating the average of all customer satisfaction ratings are used to make future adjustments and improvements.

- **Feedback Loops**:

  Use customer feedback to refine services and campaigns. Collect feedback data and send regular satisfaction questionnaires (e.g. CSAT) to clients to collect their opinions and suggestions on service quality, shooting process, post-editing, etc.

- **Competitive analysis**:

  Regularly evaluate the performance of peer competitors, including their market share, service pricing, marketing strategies, etc., and track competitors' keyword rankings, advertisements, etc. through SEMrush, Ahrefs, etc.

Conclusion and Recommendations

By capturing significant moments in children's growth, Bao-tiful Shots create lasting memories that families can cherish forever. Also, it combines with the services of traditional Chinese outfits, which are positioned uniquely in Mississauga's photography market. This approach not only differentiates the brand, but also resonates emotionally with its target audience. However, as a new company, it faces challenges with low brand awareness, fierce market competition and limited brand recognition.

To overcome these challenges, Bao-tiful Shots had to focus on building foundational brand awareness through targeted community, social media engagement, and partnerships with schools and organizations. Implementing a phased marketing plan with short, medium and long-term goals, and enabling the brand to grow steadily while optimizing resources. Encourage client recommendations and utilize cultural events to further build trust and loyalty.

By evaluating performance metrics and adapting strategies based on customer feedback and market trends. Bao-tiful Shots can achieve its goals in 2024 and also set the foundation for long-term success as a top photography brand.

References

Snap Photo Studio. (2023). *Snap Photo Studio – Professional Family Photography, Corporate Photography, Event Photography*. Snapphotostudio.ca. https://snapphotostudio.ca/

Taylor, P. (2024, January 30). *Smartphone penetration in Canada 2018-2025*. Statista. https://www.statista.com/statistics/472054/smartphone-user-penetration-in-canada/

Appendices

Appendix A

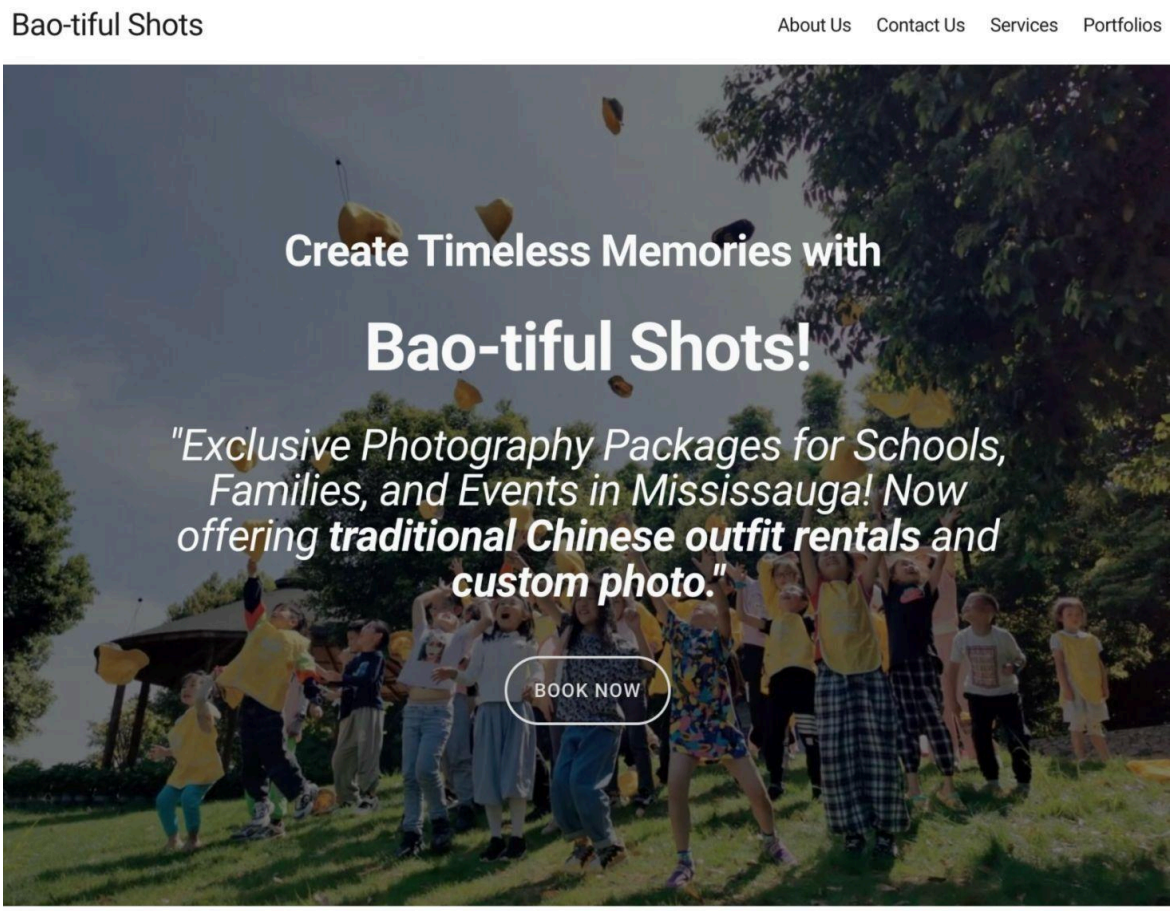
Mockup 1: Facebook Ad for Awareness (Top of the Funnel)



Appendix B



Mockup 2: Landing Page for Lead Conversion (Middle of the Funnel)





About our company

Bao-tiful Shots is a professional photography source company that focuses on capturing significant moments in children's growth, especially when they get achievements and shine.

At Bao-tiful Shots, the goal is to create valuable memories, celebrate achievements, and satisfy the emotional needs of parents and grandparents who want to preserve children's growth and accomplishments.

In the beginning, Bao-tiful Shots was a personal photography account by Clare, for sharing landscape photos from travels. While the account attracts fans by its visual appeal, it remained non-commercial. As Clare realized the growing demand for high-quality and family-focused photography. She decided to evolve the brand into a professional service, specializing in capturing moments for schools, institutions, and family events.

LEARN MORE

Our Services

Large event photography packages

Professional photography services designed for large-scale occasions such as events, competitions, and performances.



Family & small institution photography packages

Customized photography services for families, dance schools, sports clubs, and other small organizations.



Costume services

Provide traditional Chinese outfit rental services.





"Bao-tiful Shots captured my daughter's dance recital perfectly! The attention to detail, the vibrant traditional Chinese outfits, and the high-quality photos left us speechless. These are memories we'll cherish forever. Thank you for making the experience so special!"

——Lily, Mississauga Parent

"Working with Bao-tiful Shots for our school's cultural festival was a seamless experience. The team was professional, punctual, and creative, capturing every important moment with precision. The parents loved the photos, and we're already planning to book again next year!"

——Keith, Toronto Elementary School Administrator





"We were amazed at how Bao-tiful Shots brought our event to life through their photography. They didn't just take pictures—they told a story. Their cultural costume rentals were a huge hit, adding an extra layer of charm to the photos. Highly recommended!"

——Anna, Mississauga Dance Academy Event Coordinator

Contact Us

Interested in our packages? Fill out some info and we will be in touch shortly. We can't wait to hear from you!

Name (required)

First Name

Last Name

Email (required)

Message (required)

SEND